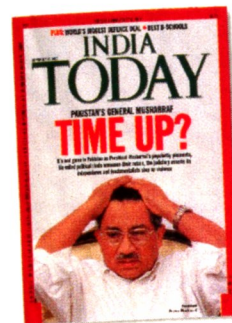


mail of the week

AP PHOTO B. K. BANGASH



"Time Up?",
September 17, 2007

"Democratic countries like India and the US need to rethink about their support to the Musharraf regime. The dictator must step down."

D.B.N. MURTHY, *Bangalore*

General Thoughts

The magazine's analysis of the current turmoil in Pakistan and India's role in the situation provided for an excellent read ("End Game", September 17). Though change of guard has never been smooth in Pakistan, it is hoped that sanity will prevail over Musharraf.

G.M. RAMA RAO, *Visakhapatnam*

Musharraf being replaced by either Benazir Bhutto or Nawaz Sharif does not seem to be a probability in a country long accustomed to the iron rod of a dictator.

J. N. BHARTIYA, *Hyderabad*

One should not write off Musharraf yet. Considering the manner in which he came to power and sent his opponents—Sharif and Bhutto—into exile, one should not be surprised if he bounces back.

VIDYA SAGAR, *Delhi*

This is the most suitable time in Pakistan's chequered history for it to be brought back on track. The country has to shatter the unholy alliance of mullahs and the radical groups, which is an arduous task. The writing on the wall is clear: get united to keep above chaos and disorder.

ARVIND K. PANDEY, *Allahabad*

It is the politicians in Pakistan and Bangladesh who are to blame for the mess the countries are in. In their zeal to finish off their opponents, the leaders create conditions in which ambitious generals like Musharraf are able to easily cease power.

M.M. GURBAXANI, *Bangalore*

If Musharraf indeed wants to prove himself as Pakistan's saviour, he should not fight shy of facing the polls. But then without the support of the army, a defanged

Musharraf might have to contend with the possibility of history repeating itself and the deposed Sharif having the last laugh.

NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN,
Thiruvananthapuram

Left with Contradictions

The US has never claimed a chunk of Indian territory *a la* China's claim of Arunachal Pradesh or never usurped a portion of India like China's occupation of the Aksai Chin ("The Karat Dogma", September 17). Yet, the Marxists take everything from the US to be detrimental to our interests. Communism, thy name is paradox.

ASOKE C. BANERJEE, *Kolkata*

Crime—a New Business

Kidnapping is fast assuming the character of an industry not unlike investing in stocks ("The Missing Kids", September 17). One's only hope lies in Bihar Chief Minister Nitish Kumar's reputation for

good governance and his ability to inject fear in the minds of hardened criminals who seem to enjoy political patronage and police protection.

H.R. BABU SATYANARAYANA,
Mysore

Dealing with Inadequacies

The Rs 40,000-crore global tender to acquire fighter aircraft brings to fore our gross inadequacy in technological progress in the much-needed spheres of development like defence ("The Mother of all Deals", September 17). Peace comes from national solidarity and strength—the focal point of preparedness—not vocal joints of conferences.

J. N. BHARTIYA, *Hyderabad*

Dot the Eye

The magazine has done a nice job of highlighting the adverse effects of technology on eyes ("Watch Those Eyes", September 17). However, it seems to have